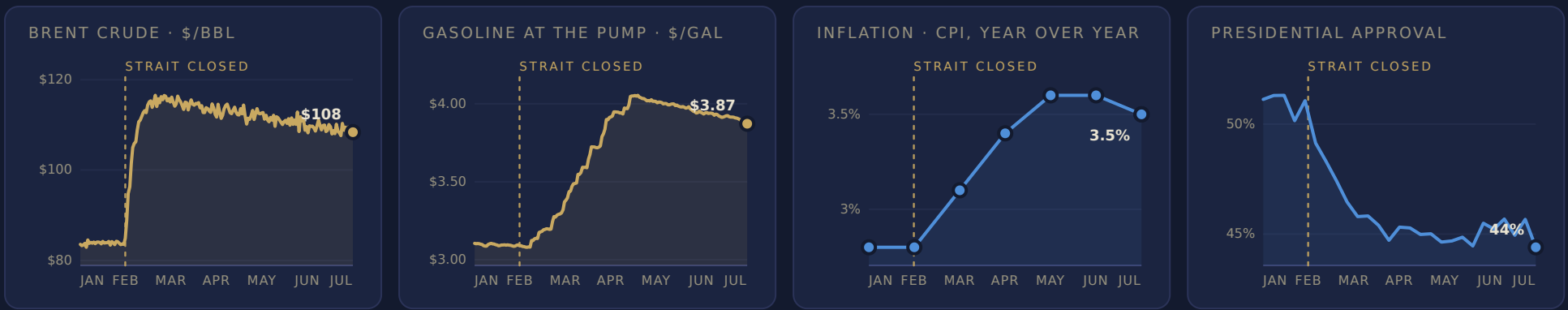


ECONOMY & INDUSTRY

I THE HORMUZ SHOCK

One closed strait, four instruments

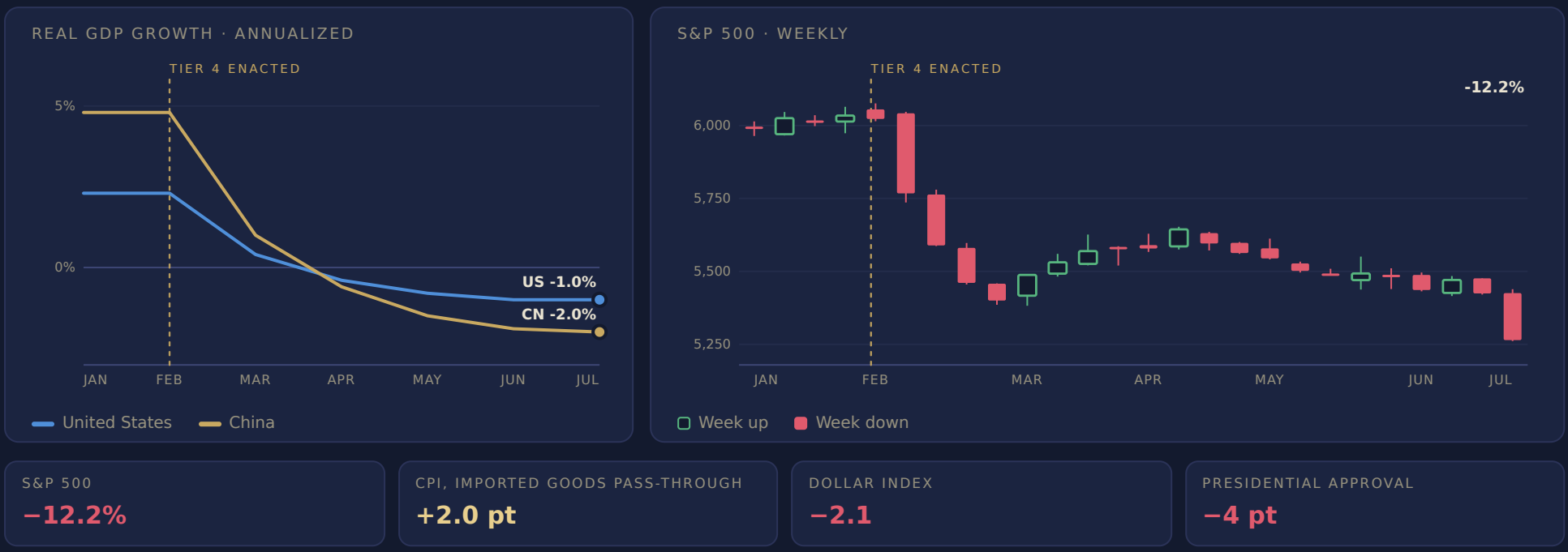
A live engine run: the Strait of Hormuz closes one month in, and the same shock is read off four different gauges. Crude reprices in days, the pump follows in weeks, the CPI print lands a month later, and approval pays for all of it. Dotted line marks the closure.



II TIER 4 ON BEIJING

Impose maximum sanctions on China and face the consequences

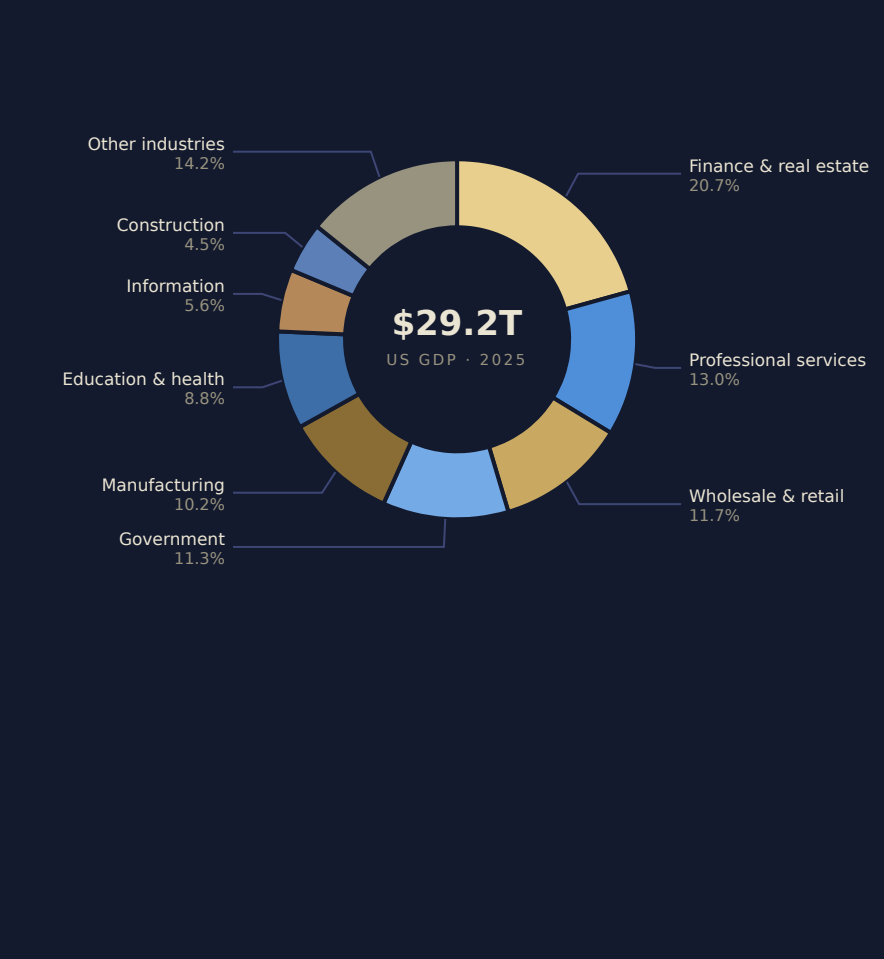
Imposing full sanctions restricts trade with the recipient country. Democratic administrations must answer to their voters, while authoritarian countries have more tolerance for pain. Hollow candles close up, filled candles close down.



III THE INDUSTRIAL BASE

Sectors of the US Economy

Every nation's GDP is composed of sectors, represented by real buildings on the map that can increase or decrease their levels.



IV THE CORPORATES

The four largest firms, trading normally

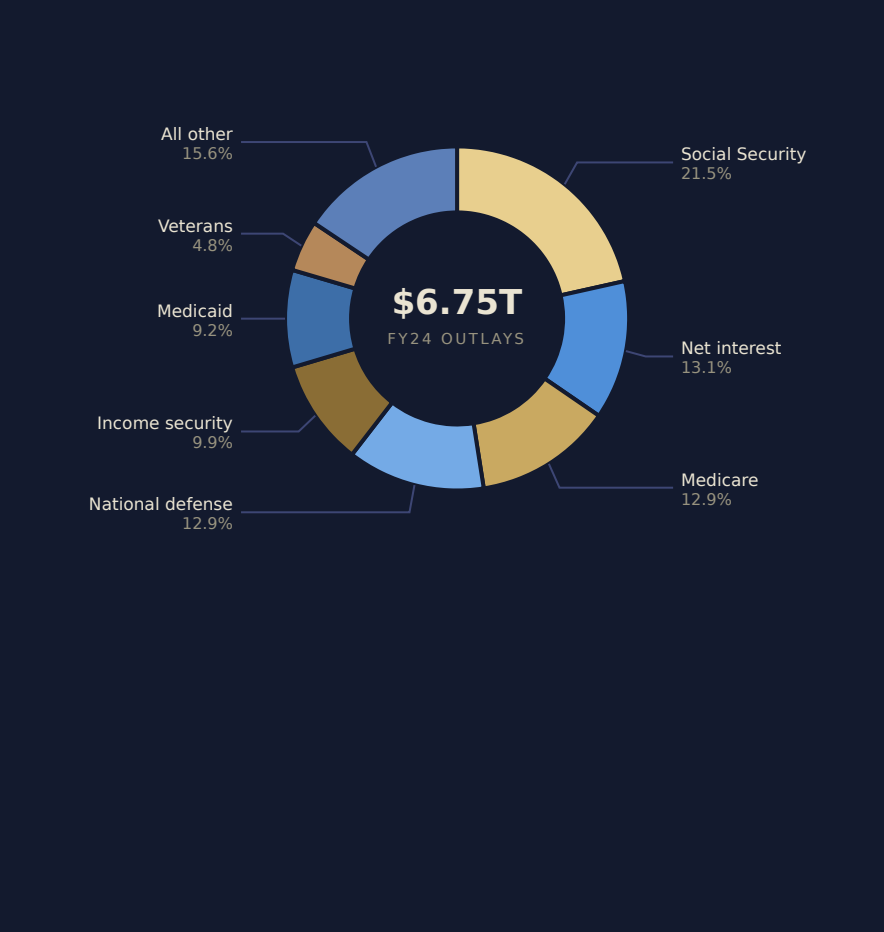
Listed companies are simulated tickers — one from each sector: tech, finance, healthcare and services. A calm month of daily candles, before you touch anything.



V THE BUDGET

Federal Budget, FY 2024

The budget the new US Administration inherits. Growing interest payments as a portion of the budget threaten long term financial stability.



VI THE BRIEFING

Economic briefing · January 20, 2025

The macroeconomic situation facing the incoming administration. This is the start of the simulation.

MEMORANDUM FOR THE PRESIDENT COUNCIL OF ECONOMIC ADVISERS · INAUGURATION DAY BRIEF · 20 JAN 2025	
GROWTH	Real GDP expanded 2.8% in 2024; the engine's 2025 baseline tracks +2.1% , cooling but above trend.
PRICES	CPI at 2.9% , core at 3.2%. Disinflation has stalled above the Federal Reserve's 2% target.
LABOR	Unemployment 4.1% ; payrolls +256k in December; wage growth 3.9% and outpacing prices.
RATES	Fed funds held at 4.25–4.50% ; markets price two cuts this year. 10-year Treasury at 4.61%.
MARKETS	S&P 500 at 5,996 . Dollar index 109 — the strongest in two years, squeezing exporters.
ENERGY	Brent \$83.81 , WTI \$77; retail gasoline \$3.11/gal. Inventories thin; Gulf transit risk is the swing factor.
FISCAL	Debt \$36.2T ; FY24 deficit \$1.83T (6.4% of GDP). Net interest now exceeds the defense budget.
RISKS	Growing interest payments threaten a debt spiral if the budget is not constrained. Voters demand greater wage growth and lower inflation. Geopolitical threats from Russia and Iran could imperil energy prices if not carefully managed.